

pretty simple. But in the gap of few seconds that occur during the time for the disc to playback, a lot of activity such as key exchange, symmetric/asymmetric encryption happens in the background.

Trying to use BD or HD DVD on a PC or on a standalone player may not be that problematic since legal software will let us do that. However, technology such as BD+ can cause a lot of heartburn for consumers.

This is because device keys and media keys are still there, with a major change. In the first steps of content decryption, a player has to find its specific key in a big ternary tree of keys, where each leaf corresponds to the key of a given device (brand and model).

By denying a drive to find its key in the tree, Blu-ray and HD-DVD can easily revoke a single given device. If, for instance, a given player is cracked and its keys are published, the licensing authority will send new keys and navigation information to disc manufacturers. As a result, all discs pressed after the player has been cracked will refuse to play on this specific drive, but will play perfectly on all other (including older) devices.

So one fine day, you could suddenly be unable to watch new movies on your player because it has been revoked after someone has successfully compromised this model. It may not matter for users who are involved in illegal practices, but it will matter to authentic users who will find themselves denied the right of watching something that they bought legally! So is this new form of copy protection good or bad? As usual, only time will tell.